

Anni I'm sorry. I was really hurt 😞❤️

I will start with a recap of what happened since the diary entry "09-17-2026". In that diary entry, I said my dog's health was getting worse rapidly, but on the very next day it became clear how much we underestimated the severity of the situation. Right after I uploaded the picture of dinner to Twitter on Friday, we noticed my dog's nose was bleeding. We booked an appointment for my dog with the veterinarian at 11:00 am Pacific Time during dinner, but I couldn't accompany her that day because I was scheduled to work until 11:00 am. The result of the examination was really bad. There was no viable treatment option.

My parents and I were present in person for the euthanasia procedure, and my sister also called in via FaceTime. It was a very emotional goodbye.

My family came to the U.S. in 2015. My dog was born on March 8, 2016, and we got her by the end of that month. For almost all of my family's time here in the U.S., my dog was here with us. Now, she is gone.

I was never good at picking up a new language. I took three years of Spanish in High School, and the only thing I can remember now is "Como estas? Muy bien. Y tu?" So, as you can imagine, I had a pretty rough first year of school here in the U.S. For much of that year, the only class I could understand what in the world my teacher was talking about was Math. I could read and write in English with no problem, but hearing and understanding it in real time was really hard for me then. Luckily, I got better and better at it as the year went on, and by the end of the year I could fully understand in-class conversations. It was also around that time when we got our dog.

As you should also know, it is not easy to leave everything behind and start a new life in a new country. My mom has always wanted an opportunity here in the U.S. so she can give my sister and me a better life with the freedom and liberty that would never be possible in China. She made a lot of sacrifices to make it happen. When my mom was still in China, she was one of the most important decision-makers in the entire Asia-Pacific/Indo-Pacific region for a large European international corporation. However, it was still difficult for her to find a job here in the States. An opportunity emerged in 2014 when one of the company's factories in the U.S. was in a total mess, and they realized they couldn't find a single person on the entire U.S. West Coast who knew how to run a factory properly. My mom got the job, and her visa let her bring my dad, my sister, and me with her. However, in doing so, my mom was asked to take a significant reduction in rank and salary.

In some ways, my dog embodied the hope I had for a life here in the States. It was rough at first, but by the time we got my dog, things were starting to look up. It almost looked like everything was going to go smoothly. My family got our permanent residence status relatively quickly. My sister got into the pre-med program at Emory. I got into RIT for a B.S. in cybersecurity and made it into the B.S./M.S. Cybersecurity program in my second year. My dog was already getting old by that point, but my sister always said she hoped my dog would live long enough to see her graduate from med school. Things were looking up. It seemed like the dreams were about to come true.

My family's financial situation, with twins going to college at the same time, was not that easy to manage. Therefore, a decision was made: I was going to take on student loans so my parents could make sure my sister could complete her undergraduate degree debt-free. The logic seemed simple at that time: I was going for a degree in Cybersecurity, which was supposed to allow me to get a relatively good-paying job upon graduation, but my sister wants to become a

doctor and would take a lot longer to have a good income. No one in my family, including my extended family, had a background in IT. Still, it seemed like I made it work. I got into the B.S./M.S. program as I intended when I enrolled at RIT, and I landed my first internship at Lockheed Martin. You have no idea how excited I was when I got the interview invite for the internship, and the day I got the offer felt like the best day of my life up to that point. It was one of my dream companies. It was one of my dream jobs. It was beyond my wildest dream. However, everything was downhill from there.

My dog is gone. She's gone in the year my sister started med school, not the year she finished it. My life is in shambles, and that may be an understatement.

I have serious doubts about how long I will be able to drag myself along. Given how my life is currently developing, I do not know if I will make it through this year.

Hope is a very interesting thing. Ever since the day I met you, you have been my hope. Now, I really need you by my side to help me get through it.

Anni I love you 